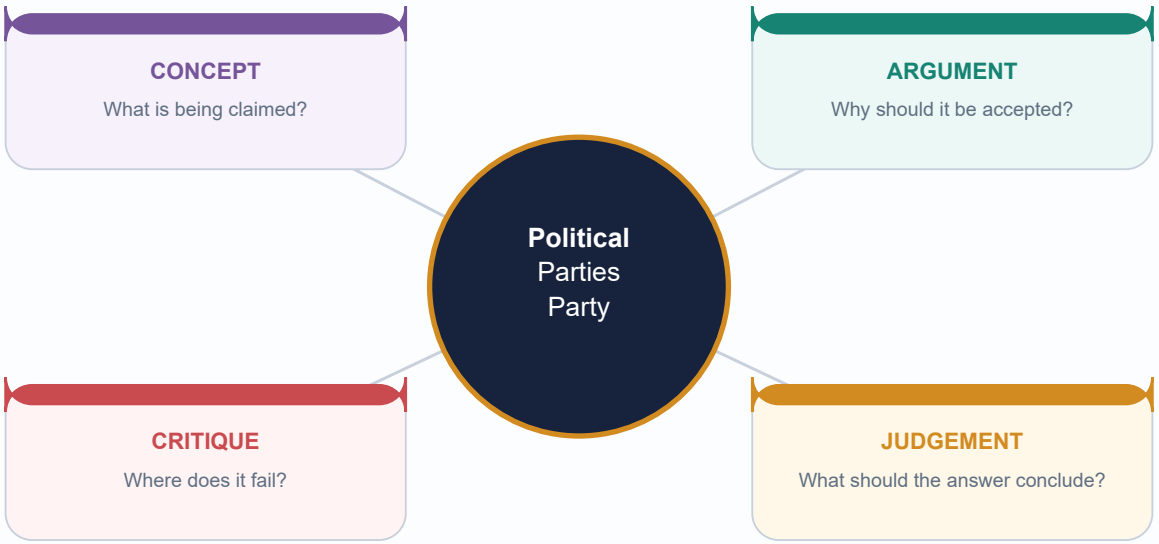
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: Political-Parties.md + 43_Political-Parties.md
Learning cards: 33



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/43_Political-Parties.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/43_Political-Parties.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/43_Political-Parties.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Registration	**Sec 29A, RPA 1951** (by the ECI)
Categories	National · State · **Registered-unrecognised**
National-party base	6% votes in **4+ states + 4 LS seats** (or alternatives)
Star campaigners	Recognised **40** · unrecognised **20**
Current recognition list	**Date-sensitive ECI order** — verify before quoting names or count

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

India has a **multi-party system** that evolved from the **"Congress system"** to competitive coalition politics. The **ECI** grants **national/state** recognition based on **poll performance**, which brings a **reserved symbol** and other privileges.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 India has a multi-party system that evolved from the "Congress system" to competitive coalition politics. The ECI grants national/state recognition ba	**Dimension 2** □ National party — any one of: 6% in 4+ states + 4 LS seats · 2% LS seats from 3 states · state party
Dimension 3 in 4 states.	**Dimension 4** □ Recognised parties get a reserved symbol + 40 star campaigners; unrecognised pick a free symbol + 20.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **National party** — any one of: **6% in 4+ states + 4 LS seats** · **2% LS seats from 3 states** · **state party

- in 4 states**.

- □ Recognised parties get a **reserved symbol** + **40 star campaigners**; unrecognised pick a **free symbol** + 20.

MEMORY HOOK

National party — any one of: 6% in 4+ states + 4 LS seats · 2% LS seats from 3 states · state party | Recognised parties get a reserved symbol + 40 star campaigners; unrecognised pick a free symbol + 20.**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Registered under **Section 29A of the RPA, 1951**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 □ Registered under Section 29A of the RPA, 1951.	**Dimension 2** □ Rajni Kothari → "one-party dominance / Congress system."
Dimension 3 □ Recognition privileges: reserved symbol, broadcast time, one proposer, electoral-roll access.	

STATIC THEORY

- □ Rajni Kothari → **"one-party dominance / Congress system."**
- □ Recognition privileges: reserved symbol, broadcast time, one proposer, electoral-roll access.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Registered under **Section 29A of the RPA, 1951**.

2. Rajni Kothari → **"one-party dominance / Congress system."**

3. Recognition privileges: reserved symbol, broadcast time, one proposer, electoral-roll access.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Electoral Bonds struck down** by the SC (**ADR case, Feb 2024**) as unconstitutional (right to information). **ECI recognition orders are performance-based and date-sensitive**; use the current notified list only when a question requires it, with an access date. The RTI/inner-party-democracy debate continues.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Purpose: make this Core file independently able to answer directive-sensitive GS-II questions on the constitutional and statutory basis of parties, party finance and the electoral-bonds verdict, criminalisation and internal democracy, and the party-system half of the centralisation debate — without opening Advanced. Party-recognition thresholds and national-party counts change by ECI order; treat every number as re-verifiable, not eternal.

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

2022 · GS-II · Q13 *— Demand (neutral rendering): national parties favour centralisation while regional parties favour State autonomy. Directive:* ***Comment*** *·* ***15 marks · 250 words****. Shared with basic/Federal-System.md, which owns the* ***federal half****;* ***this file owns the party-system half*** *(why parties behave as they do). Cross-link, do not duplicate.* ***Core routing supersedes the older advanced/43_Political-Parties.md pointer for this demand.***

Executable route (party-system half): *(1)* ***Thesis*** *— the correlation is broadly observable but tracks a party's position in the power structure and organisational form, not a fixed ideology; it reverses when a party moves between the Union and the States. (2)* ***Why a national party leans central*** *— a pan-Indian party that holds or seeks the Union internalises the gains of a strong Centre (All-India Services, Union List dominance, central schemes) and prefers uniform national programmes; its high command model (weak internal federalism, Sec 29A registration without a statutory internal-democracy code) rewards centralised control. (3)* ***Why regional parties lean to autonomy*** *— parties recognised as* ***State parties*** *under the ECI's Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment)* ***Order, 1968*** *draw their vote from a single State's identity, language or sub-region, so fiscal devolution, a restrained Governor and resistance to scheme conditionalities are electoral necessities. (4)* ***Counter-evidence*** *— in the coalition era (1989–2014) regional parties in central coalitions bargained for States while national parties conceded autonomy; regional parties centralise* ***within*** *their own States; a national party in State opposition itself demands autonomy. (5)* ***Federal-design frame*** *— cross-link basic/Federal-System.md §8 (14 unitary features; S.R. Bommai 1994 federalism-as-basic-feature floor) rather than re-deriving it. (6)* ***Verdict*** *— preference follows incentives and organisational form, so the durable safeguard of autonomy is institutional (Finance Commission, Inter-State Council, judicial review), not partisan intent — qualified agreement, not a law of party behaviour.*

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Constitutional/statutory basis of parties	"regulation of parties", "are parties above the law", Discuss	Silence of original text → Tenth Schedule + Sec 29A → Symbols Order + *Sadiq Ali* → gaps → reform verdict
Party finance & transparency	"money power", "electoral bonds", "opacity", Critically examine	Legal sources → anonymity problem → 2024 ADR verdict → residual gaps → verdict
Criminalisation of politics	"decriminalise", "criminal antecedents", Examine	Scale → disclosure directions → *Lily Thomas* → why laws under-bite → verdict
Internal democracy & dynasticism	"inner-party democracy", "high command", Comment	No statutory code → ECI/committee record → dynastic incentive → reform options
Party system evolution	"one-party dominance to coalition", "fourth party system", Analyse	Phase-by-phase → what changed and why → current phase → qualified label
Centralisation vs autonomy	"national vs regional parties", Comment	Incentive/organisation logic → both-sides evidence → institutional verdict (§5.0)
Regionalisation of politics	"strength or threat to federal democracy", Discuss	Deepened representation → governance costs → net assessment

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

India's parties are heavily regulated at the entry and symbol stage yet almost unregulated internally: the Constitution names the party only to punish defection (Tenth Schedule), the statute registers it (Sec 29A), and the ECI disciplines its symbol (1968 Order) — but no law compels internal democracy, so accountability is strong outward and weak inward.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1
India's parties are heavily regulated at the entry and symbol stage yet almost unregulated internally: the Constitution names the party only to punish

Dimension 2
The 2024 electoral-bonds verdict reframed party finance as a voter's right-to-know problem rather than a donor's privacy problem, but striking down on

Dimension 3
Criminalisation persists not for want of judicial directions but because disqualification bites only after conviction while selection incentives rewar

Dimension 4
Party preferences on centralisation are a function of who holds the Union and of organisational form, not of ideology, which is why the same party cen

STATIC THEORY

- The 2024 electoral-bonds verdict reframed party finance as a voter's right-to-know problem rather than a donor's privacy problem, but striking down one instrument did not by itself close the wider anonymity and corporate-funding gap.

- Criminalisation persists not for want of judicial directions but because disqualification bites only after conviction while selection incentives reward "winnability"; the binding change came from Lily Thomas *removing the sitting-member shield, not from exhortation.*

- Party preferences on centralisation are a function of who holds the Union and of organisational form, not of ideology, which is why the same party centralises in office and demands autonomy in opposition.

- Regionalisation has widened representation and made federalism a lived bargain, but it has also fragmented mandates and raised the transaction costs of national decision-making — a democratisation with a coordination price.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → two dimensions (e.g. legal basis + one gap) → one qualification → verdict	3 units, at least one Article/Act + one case
15	Thesis → basis → the specific problem (finance / criminalisation / autonomy) → counter-evidence → qualified verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → constitutional-statutory frame → finance → criminalisation/internal democracy → system evolution → reform menu → graded verdict	6–8 units + a "regulate what, and how far" paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Constitutional & statutory basis (Claim → provision → mechanism → limitation)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Claim: the Constitution's *original* text did not mention parties; recognition entered only in 1985. **Provision:** the **Tenth Schedule** (inserted by the **52nd Amendment, 1985**) is the first constitutional text to define and empower the "political party" — for the purpose of **disqualification on defection**. **Mechanism:** it ties a legislator's seat to the party whip, converting the party into a constitutional actor. **Limitation:** it regulates loyalty, not internal democracy or finance — a narrow constitutional footing (defection interface developed in basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.4 BANK A — CONSTITUTIONAL & STATUTORY BASIS (CLAIM → PROVISION → MECHANISM → LIMITATION): RECALL MAP

5.4 Bank A — Constitutional & statutory basis (Claim → provision → mechanism → limitation)

V

Dimension 1 Claim: the Constitution's original text did not mention parties; recognition entered only in 1985. Provision: the Tenth Schedule (inserted by the 52	**Dimension 2** Claim: registration is statutory, not constitutional. Provision: Section 29A, Representation of the People Act, 1951 — every association seeking to
Dimension 3 Claim: recognition and symbols are an ECI administrative-cum-quasi-judicial function. Provision: the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Or	**Dimension 4** Claim: the ECI's symbol-dispute power is judicially upheld. Case: Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India (1972) — the Supreme Court sustained the

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Claim:** registration is statutory, not constitutional. **Provision: Section 29A, Representation of the People Act, 1951** — every association seeking to be a party must register with the **ECI** and swear allegiance to the Constitution, socialism, secularism and democracy. **Mechanism:** registration confers statutory status under the RPA and connects to tax/disclosure consequences, but it does **not create the association itself** and does **not** confer recognition. **Limitation:** the ECI's power to *register* is not matched by an express power to *de-register* an inactive or errant party — a recognised statutory gap.

- □ **Claim:** recognition and symbols are an ECI administrative-cum-quasi-judicial function. **Provision:** the **Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968** — an ECI order issued under Article 324 read with Rules 5 and 10 of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961 — sets the **National / State / registered-unrecognised** categories, allots **reserved symbols** to recognised parties and free symbols to the rest, and empowers the ECI to decide disputes between rival factions claiming the party and its symbol. **Mechanism:** the categories are prescribed by the **ECI Order and revised periodically** (thresholds were relaxed in 2011; reviews recur), so they are policy, not entrenched law. **Limitation:** because it is executive-made, criteria and counts shift by order — never cite a threshold or a national-party count as fixed.

- □ **Claim:** the ECI's symbol-dispute power is judicially upheld. **Case:** *Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India* (**1972**) — the Supreme Court sustained the ECI's authority under the 1968 Order to decide which faction is the "real" party, applying the **test of majority** across the party's organisational and legislative wings (the "*Sadiq Ali* test"). **Mechanism:** it makes the ECI a quasi-judicial arbiter of party identity, not merely a registrar. **Limitation:** the majority test can privilege the legislative/organisational count over the rank and file, and recurs in every high-profile split.

- □ **Claim:** the defection interface makes the party a disciplinary authority over its own legislators. **Provision:** the **Tenth Schedule** disqualifies a member who defies the party whip or voluntarily gives up membership; the **91st Amendment (2003)** deleted the earlier one-third "**split**" exemption, so only a **two-thirds merger** now escapes disqualification, and it **barred a disqualified defector from ministerial or remunerative political office**. **Mechanism:** it converts party loyalty into a condition of holding the seat; the **Speaker/Chairman adjudicates**, subject to judicial review (*Kihoto Hollohan*, **1992**). **Limitation:** □□ it strengthens the **high command** against the individual legislator — deepening the internal-democracy problem (full treatment in basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md).

- □ **Three legal layers: Constitution** (Tenth Schedule — defection) · **Statute** (Sec 29A — registration) · **ECI Order** (1968 — recognition & symbol). Distinguish them in every "how are parties regulated" answer.

MEMORY HOOK

Three legal layers: Constitution (Tenth Schedule — defection) · Statute (Sec 29A — registration) · ECI Order (1968 — recognition & symbol). Distinguish them in every "how are parties regulated" answer.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: the Constitution's *original* text did not mention parties; recognition entered only in 1985. **Provision:** the **Tenth Schedule** (inserted by the **52nd Amendment, 1985**) is the first constitutional text to define and empower the "political party" — for the purpose of **disqualification on defection**. **Mechanism:** it ties a legislator's seat to the party whip, converting the party into a constitutional actor. **Limitation:** it regulates loyalty, not internal democracy or finance — a narrow constitutional footing (defection interface developed in basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md).

2. Claim: registration is statutory, not constitutional. **Provision: Section 29A, Representation of the People Act, 1951** — every association seeking to be a party must register with the **ECI** and swear allegiance to the Constitution, socialism, secularism and democracy. **Mechanism:** registration confers statutory status under the RPA and connects to tax/disclosure consequences, but it does **not create the association itself** and does **not** confer recognition. **Limitation:** the ECI's power to *register* is not matched by an express power to *de-register* an inactive or errant party — a recognised statutory gap.

3. Claim: recognition and symbols are an ECI administrative-cum-quasi-judicial function. **Provision:** the **Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968** — an ECI order issued under Article 324 read with Rules 5 and 10 of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961 — sets the **National / State / registered-unrecognised** categories, allots **reserved symbols** to recognised parties and free symbols to the rest, and empowers the ECI to decide disputes between rival factions claiming the party and its symbol. **Mechanism:** the categories are prescribed by the **ECI Order and revised periodically** (thresholds were relaxed in 2011; reviews recur), so they are policy, not entrenched law. **Limitation:** because it is executive-made, criteria and counts shift by order — never cite a threshold or a national-party count as fixed.

4. Claim: the ECI's symbol-dispute power is judicially upheld. **Case:** *Sadiq Ali v. Election Commission of India* (**1972**) — the Supreme Court sustained the ECI's authority under the 1968 Order to decide which faction is the "real" party, applying the **test of majority** across the party's organisational and legislative wings (the "*Sadiq Ali* test"). **Mechanism:** it makes the ECI a quasi-judicial arbiter of party identity, not merely a registrar. **Limitation:** the majority test can privilege the legislative/organisational count over the rank and file, and recurs in every high-profile split.

5. Claim: the defection interface makes the party a disciplinary authority over its own legislators. **Provision:** the **Tenth Schedule** disqualifies a member who defies the party whip or voluntarily gives up membership; the **91st Amendment (2003)** deleted the earlier one-third "**split**" exemption, so only a **two-thirds merger** now escapes disqualification, and it **barred a disqualified defector from ministerial or remunerative political office**. **Mechanism:** it converts party loyalty into a condition of holding the seat; the **Speaker/Chairman adjudicates**, subject to judicial review (*Kihoto Hollohan*, **1992**). **Limitation:** □□ it strengthens the **high command** against the individual legislator — deepening the internal-democracy problem (full treatment in basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Constitutional & statutory basis (Claim → provision → mechanism → limitation)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Party finance and the electoral-bonds verdict (routed to the 2024 proposition)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Contribution and disclosure spine: RPA Section 29B** permits contributions subject to the statutory foreign-source prohibition; **Section 29C** requires the treasurer/authorised person to report contributions **exceeding ₹20,000** from a person or company to the ECI before the income-tax return due date, with tax-relief consequences for non-reporting. This threshold is distinct from cash-receipt limits under tax law and from candidate-expenditure rules.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — PARTY FINANCE AND THE ELECTORAL-BONDS VERDICT (ROUTED TO THE 2024 PROPOSITION): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — Party finance and the electoral-bonds verdict (routed to the 2024 proposition)

V

Dimension 1 □ Contribution and disclosure spine: RPA Section 29B permits contributions subject to the statutory foreign-source prohibition; Section 29C requires t	**Dimension 2** □ Foreign contribution control: the FCRA, 2010 prohibits political parties and specified political actors from accepting foreign contribution. Apply t
Dimension 3 □ Claim: party income is legally sourced but weakly transparent. Provisions: contributions are permitted (companies may donate under the Companies Act	**Dimension 4** □ Claim: the Supreme Court has recast anonymous corporate funding as a right-to-know violation. Case (exact proposition): Association for Democratic R

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Foreign contribution control:** the **FCRA, 2010** prohibits political parties and specified political actors from accepting foreign contribution. Apply the Act's current “foreign source” definition rather than assuming every Indian-incorporated subsidiary is foreign.

- □ **Claim:** party income is legally sourced but weakly transparent. **Provisions:** contributions are permitted (companies may donate under the **Companies Act, 2013, Sec 182**; **electoral trusts** are recognised), and **Section 29C, RPA 1951** requires a party to report to the ECI contributions **above a statutory threshold** (□ a fixed rupee figure set by statute/rules — verify the current amount before quoting it). **Mechanism:** reporting is meant to expose large donors. **Limitation:** anonymous small-cash and instrument-based routes historically escaped disclosure.

- □ **Claim:** the Supreme Court has recast anonymous corporate funding as a right-to-know violation. **Case (exact proposition):** *Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India* (**February 2024**, five-judge Constitution Bench) **struck down the Electoral Bond Scheme, 2018** and the enabling amendments (to the RPA, the Companies Act and the Income-tax Act) as **unconstitutional for violating the voter's right to information under Article 19(1)(a)**, and held that unlimited, anonymous corporate funding is not saved by donor privacy; it **directed the State Bank of India to disclose** bond purchaser and encashment data to the ECI. **Mechanism:** it re-anchored campaign-finance law in the informed vote rather than donor confidentiality. **Limitation:** □□ striking one instrument does not by itself cap corporate donations or mandate a comprehensive disclosure regime — the wider anonymity and quid-pro-quo problem remains open.

- □□ **Claim:** reform proposals predate the verdict. **Evidence:** the **Indrajit Gupta Committee (1998)** recommended partial **State funding** of elections in kind; the **Law Commission's 255th Report (2015)** proposed tighter disclosure and donation controls. **Significance:** the debate is between transparency-plus-caps and State funding. **Limitation:** none has been enacted as a complete scheme; treat as recommendations, not law.

- □/□ **Claim:** corporate-funding transparency was diluted before 2024 and partly restored by the verdict. **Provision:** the **Finance Act, 2017** had **removed the earlier profit-linked cap** on company donations (Companies Act 2013, Sec 182) and the requirement to **name the recipient party** in company accounts; the **2024 ADR** judgment **struck those changes down** with the bond scheme. **Mechanism:** it restored the corporate-disclosure baseline. **Limitation:** □□ do **not** quote donation caps or percentages as current — the statutory position has shifted and remains contested.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Contribution and disclosure spine: RPA Section 29B permits contributions subject to the statutory foreign-source prohibition; **Section 29C** requires the treasurer/authorised person to report contributions **exceeding ₹20,000** from a person or company to the ECI before the income-tax return due date, with tax-relief consequences for non-reporting. This threshold is distinct from cash-receipt limits under tax law and from candidate-expenditure rules.

2. Foreign contribution control: the **FCRA, 2010** prohibits political parties and specified political actors from accepting foreign contribution. Apply the Act's current "foreign source" definition rather than assuming every Indian-incorporated subsidiary is foreign.

3. Claim: party income is legally sourced but weakly transparent. **Provisions:** contributions are permitted (companies may donate under the **Companies Act, 2013, Sec 182**; **electoral trusts** are recognised), and **Section 29C, RPA 1951** requires a party to report to the ECI contributions **above a statutory threshold** (a fixed rupee figure set by statute/rules — verify the current amount before quoting it). **Mechanism:** reporting is meant to expose large donors. **Limitation:** anonymous small-cash and instrument-based routes historically escaped disclosure.

4. Claim: the Supreme Court has recast anonymous corporate funding as a right-to-know violation. **Case (exact proposition):** *Association for Democratic Reforms v. Union of India* (**February 2024**, five-judge Constitution Bench) **struck down the Electoral Bond Scheme, 2018** and the enabling amendments (to the RPA, the Companies Act and the Income-tax Act) as **unconstitutional for violating the voter's right to information under Article 19(1)(a)**, and held that unlimited, anonymous corporate funding is not saved by donor privacy; it **directed the State Bank of India to disclose** bond purchaser and encashment data to the ECI. **Mechanism:** it re-anchored campaign-finance law in the informed vote rather than donor confidentiality. **Limitation:** striking one instrument does not by itself cap corporate donations or mandate a comprehensive disclosure regime — the wider anonymity and quid-pro-quo problem remains open.

5. / **Claim:** corporate-funding transparency was diluted before 2024 and partly restored by the verdict. **Provision:** the **Finance Act, 2017** had **removed the earlier profit-linked cap** on company donations (Companies Act 2013, Sec 182) and the requirement to **name the recipient party** in company accounts; the **2024 ADR** judgment **struck those changes down** with the bond scheme. **Mechanism:** it restored the corporate-disclosure baseline. **Limitation:** do **not** quote donation caps or percentages as current — the statutory position has shifted and remains contested.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Party finance and the electoral-bonds verdict (routed to the 2024 proposition)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — Criminalisation and internal democracy (mechanism, incentives and consequences)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: disclosure of criminal antecedents is now mandatory, by judicial direction, not by a fresh statute. **Cases:** *Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms* (**2002**) and *PUCL v. Union of India* (**2003**) established the voter's **right to know** and the **candidate-affidavit** requirement on criminal, financial and educational background; *Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora* (**2020**) directed **parties** to publish candidates' criminal antecedents and reasons for selection on their websites. **Mechanism:** it works by publicity, leaving the *choice* to voters and parties. **Limitation:** disclosure has not reduced the share of candidates with cases, because selection rewards "winnability".

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.6 BANK C — CRIMINALISATION AND INTERNAL DEMOCRACY (MECHANISM, INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES): RECALL MAP

5.6 Bank C — Criminalisation and internal democracy (mechanism, incentives and consequences)

V

Dimension 1 □ Claim: disclosure of criminal antecedents is now mandatory, by judicial direction, not by a fresh statute. Cases: Union of India v. Association for	**Dimension 2** □ Claim: the one change that actually removed sitting offenders was judicial excision of a statutory shield. Case (exact proposition): Lily Thomas v.
Dimension 3 □/□□ Claim: internal democracy is the least-regulated frontier. Evidence: there is no statutory code compelling internal elections; parties file organ	

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Claim:** the one change that actually removed sitting offenders was judicial excision of a statutory shield. **Case (exact proposition):** *Lily Thomas v. Union of India* (**2013**) struck down **Section 8(4) of the RPA, 1951**, so a sitting MP or MLA **convicted** of an offence carrying the disqualifying sentence is disqualified **immediately**, without the earlier protection pending appeal. **Mechanism:** it aligned sitting members with candidates. **Limitation:** disqualification still bites only **after conviction**, and trials are slow — hence the demand for special courts and a lifetime ban (pending policy, not law).

- □/□□ **Claim:** internal democracy is the least-regulated frontier. **Evidence:** there is **no statutory code** compelling internal elections; parties file organisational-election particulars with the ECI, but compliance is formal and the **high-command / dynastic** model dominates candidate selection and finance. **Mechanism:** without an internal-democracy law, leadership succession and ticket distribution stay discretionary. **Limitation:** □□ proposals (Law Commission 170th Report, 1999; ECI's recurring pleas) to legislate inner-party democracy have not been adopted — cite them as reform demands, not existing obligations.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim: disclosure of criminal antecedents is now mandatory, by judicial direction, not by a fresh statute. **Cases:** *Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms* (**2002**) and *PUCL v. Union of India* (**2003**) established the voter's **right to know** and the **candidate-affidavit** requirement on criminal, financial and educational background; *Rambabu Singh Thakur v. Sunil Arora* (**2020**) directed **parties** to publish candidates' criminal antecedents and reasons for selection on their websites. **Mechanism:** it works by publicity, leaving the *choice* to voters and parties. **Limitation:** disclosure has not reduced the share of candidates with cases, because selection rewards "winnability".

2. Claim: the one change that actually removed sitting offenders was judicial excision of a statutory shield. **Case (exact proposition):** *Lily Thomas v. Union of India* (**2013**) struck down **Section 8(4) of the RPA, 1951**, so a sitting MP or MLA **convicted** of an offence carrying the disqualifying sentence is disqualified **immediately**, without the earlier protection pending appeal. **Mechanism:** it aligned sitting members with candidates. **Limitation:** disqualification still bites only **after conviction**, and trials are slow — hence the demand for special courts and a lifetime ban (pending policy, not law).

3. /□□ **Claim:** internal democracy is the least-regulated frontier. **Evidence:** there is **no statutory code** compelling internal elections; parties file organisational-election particulars with the ECI, but compliance is formal and the **high-command / dynastic** model dominates candidate selection and finance. **Mechanism:** without an internal-democracy law, leadership succession and ticket distribution stay discretionary. **Limitation:** □□ proposals (Law Commission 170th Report, 1999; ECI's recurring pleas) to legislate inner-party democracy have not been adopted — cite them as reform demands, not existing obligations.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — Criminalisation and internal democracy (mechanism, incentives and consequences)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Evolution of the party system (analytical, not just chronological)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Phase	Character	What changed and why (analysis)
□ **One-party dominance (1952–1967)**	Rajni Kothari's **"Congress system"**	Congress was hegemonic yet internally plural — an "umbrella" that absorbed factions and functioned as a system of consensus with margins of pressure; opposition survived at the edges.
□/□□ **Fragmentation & first coalitions (1967–1989)**	Congress loses many States in 1967; Janata (1977)	Social coalitions broke, regional and backward-class assertion rose; the *dominance* model ended even before the Centre changed hands durably.
□/□□ **Coalition era (1989–2014)**	National Front / UF / NDA / UPA	No single-party Lok Sabha majority; **regional parties became pivotal**, extracting fiscal and portfolio concessions — federalism's most bargained phase.
□□ **Dominance and renewed coalition dependence (2014 onward)**	single-party Union majorities in 2014/2019; coalition-supported government after the 2024 election	Central dominance coexists with strong State parties, but the 2024 result restored coalition dependence; treat phase labels as analysis, not constitutional fact.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Evolution of the party system (analytical, not just chronological)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Evolution of the party system (analytical, not just chronological)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analytical use: the phases explain the centralisation debate — dominance and single-party majorities pull central; fragmentation and regional pivotality pull federal.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Evolution of the party system (analytical, not just chronological)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Over-regulated outside, under-regulated inside: □□ entry (Sec 29A) and symbols (1968 Order) are tightly controlled, but internal democracy and finance are not — the central critique of the Indian party.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.8 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT AND REGIONAL VARIATION: RECALL MAP

5.8 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

V

Dimension 1 Over-regulated outside, under-regulated inside: □□ entry (Sec 29A) and symbols (1968 Order) are tightly controlled, but internal democracy and finance	**Dimension 2** Regionalisation — the two-sided argument: □□ For: regional parties deepened representation of language, region and backward groups, made federalism a
Dimension 3 Finance: □□ even after the 2024 verdict, corporate and anonymous funding routes and the absence of donation caps keep the money-power critique alive.	**Dimension 4** Implementation constraint: □□ the ECI can register but struggles to de-register, and disclosure directions depend on voter response — regulatory reach

STATIC THEORY

- **Regionalisation — the two-sided argument:** □□ *For:* regional parties deepened representation of language, region and backward groups, made federalism a lived bargain, and improved governance responsiveness in several States. *Against:* they can fragment mandates, raise coalition transaction costs, personalise and dynasticise power, and pursue sub-national rather than national interests. The honest verdict is **democratisation with a coordination cost**, not an unqualified good or ill.

- **Finance:** □□ even after the 2024 verdict, corporate and anonymous funding routes and the absence of donation caps keep the money-power critique alive.

- **Implementation constraint:** □□ the ECI can register but struggles to **de-register**, and disclosure directions depend on voter response — regulatory reach exceeds regulatory bite.

- **Documented criminalisation:** □□ the **Vohra Committee Report (1993)** officially recorded the **criminal–politician–bureaucrat nexus**; it is the standard citation for the *scale* of criminalisation, though its full findings were never published — cite it as an official acknowledgement, not a data source.

- **Old, cross-partisan reform demand:** □□ the **Dinesh Goswami Committee (1990)**, the **Indrajit Gupta Committee (1998)** on state funding, the **Law Commission 170th (1999)** and **255th (2015)** Reports, and the **NCRWC (2002)** all urged inner-party democracy, transparent finance and decriminalisation — the agenda is settled in principle and unlegislated in fact.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Criticism, counter-argument and regional variation

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Regulation verdict: "India regulates the party at its edges — birth, symbol and defection — but leaves its interior to convention; the reform frontier is inner-party democracy and finance, not registration."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.9 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.9 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Regulation verdict: "India regulates the party at its edges — birth, symbol and defection — but leaves its interior to convention; the reform frontier	**Dimension 2** Finance verdict: "The 2024 electoral-bonds judgment restored the voter's right to know, but transparency without caps is a floor, not a ceiling — the
Dimension 3 Centralisation verdict: "National and regional parties tilt central and federal not by conviction but by position and organisational form; the safegua	**Dimension 4** Criminalisation verdict: "The Court has forced disclosure — Lily Thomas and the candidate-antecedents directions — but disqualification still waits on

STATIC THEORY

- **Finance verdict:** "The 2024 electoral-bonds judgment restored the voter's right to know, but transparency without caps is a floor, not a ceiling — the funding question is reopened, not closed."

- **Centralisation verdict:** "National and regional parties tilt central and federal not by conviction but by position and organisational form; the safeguard of autonomy is therefore institutional, not partisan."

- **Criminalisation verdict:** "The Court has forced disclosure — *Lily Thomas* and the candidate-antecedents directions — but disqualification still waits on conviction; the gap between *known* and *proven* criminality is where reform now sits."

- **Reform-locus verdict:** "Every major committee since 1990 has converged on the same three fixes — internal democracy, transparent finance and decriminalisation — so the deficit is political will, not institutional imagination."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Where parties are *registered*	**Section 29A, RPA 1951** (a statute) — **not** the Constitution
Where parties are first *named* in the Constitution	The **Tenth Schedule** (52nd Amendment, 1985), for **anti-defection** only
Recognition categories & symbols	The **Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968** (an ECI order), **not** the RPA sections directly
Faction/symbol disputes	Decided by the **ECI** under the 1968 Order; upheld in *Sadiq Ali* (1972) — **not** by the High Court in the first instance
Reserved vs free symbol	**Recognised** parties get a **reserved** symbol; **registered-unrecognised** choose from **free** symbols
Star campaigners	RPA Section 77 explanation: recognised party = **40**, other party = **20**; verify any later amendment
Lily Thomas (2013)	Struck **Sec 8(4) RPA** → immediate disqualification of convicted sitting members; it is **not** the electoral-bonds case
Electoral-bonds case	*ADR v. Union of India* (**Feb 2024**) under **Art 19(1)(a)** — right to information

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
National-party count	□ fixed by ECI order and **changes** — do not memorise a number as permanent
"National party" meaning	A **recognition/privilege** category — not a party that contests only national elections
52nd vs 91st Amendment	**52nd (1985)** created the Tenth Schedule; **91st (2003)** deleted the one-third **split** exception and capped the Council of Ministers — do not merge the two
Symbol-dispute forum	The **ECI** (quasi-judicial) under the **1968 Order** decides first; courts intervene only on **review** — not the High Court in the first instance
Registration vs recognition	**Any** party may **register** (Sec 29A); only a party crossing prescribed poll thresholds is **recognised** (State/national)
Vohra Committee subject	**Criminalisation / criminal–politician nexus (1993)** — not party finance or symbols
NCRWC vs Vohra vs Goswami	**NCRWC (2002)** = constitutional review; **Vohra (1993)** = criminal nexus; **Goswami (1990)** = electoral reform — distinct mandates

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Recognition thresholds and party status change by ECI order.** State the criteria structure and cross-link basic/Election-Commission.md; if a count or list is indispensable, cite the current ECI order and access date. □ **Distinguish the legal layers:** Tenth Schedule (Constitution) ≠ Sec 29A (statute) ≠ 1968 Symbols Order (ECI subordinate order). Do not attribute registration to the Constitution or recognition to the RPA sections alone. □ **Electoral bonds:** the scheme was **struck down (Feb 2024)**; do not describe it as an operative funding route. Cite *ADR* as a **right-to-information (Art 19(1)(a))** holding.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Do not quantify** party income, corporate-donation shares or bond values from memory; funding figures change and are contested.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.11 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 □□ Do not quantify party income, corporate-donation shares or bond values from memory; funding figures change and are contested.	**Dimension 2** □ Lily Thomas (2013) removed the sitting-member shield (Sec 8(4)); it did not create a lifetime ban — a lifetime ban remains a proposal, not law.
Dimension 3 □□ Party-system "phases" and the post-2014 label are characterisations, not constitutional facts — mark them as analysis.	**Dimension 4** □□ Committee reports (Indrajit Gupta 1998; Law Commission 170th/255th) are recommendations; State funding and a statutory internal-democracy code are

STATIC THEORY

- □ *Lily Thomas* (2013) removed the **sitting-member shield (Sec 8(4))**; it did **not** create a lifetime ban — a lifetime ban remains a **proposal**, not law.

- □□ Party-system "phases" and the post-2014 label are **characterisations**, not constitutional facts — mark them as analysis.

- □□ Committee reports (Indrajit Gupta 1998; Law Commission 170th/255th) are **recommendations**; State funding and a statutory internal-democracy code are **not** enacted.

- □□ **NCRWC (2002)** proposed regulating parties' internal functioning and finances by law; treat it as a **recommendation**, not existing law.

- □ **Star-campaigner ceilings (40 for a recognised political party and 20 for another political party)** arise from the explanation to **RPA Section 77** — cite the structure, verify the current figure before quoting.

- □ Distinguish the **52nd Amendment (1985, Tenth Schedule)** from the **91st Amendment (2003, deletion of the split exception + CoM cap)** — a common Prelims trap.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. *Lily Thomas* (2013) removed the **sitting-member shield (Sec 8(4))**; it did **not** create a lifetime ban — a lifetime ban remains a **proposal**, not law.

2. Star-campaigner ceilings (40 for a recognised political party and 20 for another political party) arise from the explanation to **RPA Section 77** — cite the structure, verify the current figure before quoting.

3. Distinguish the **52nd Amendment (1985, Tenth Schedule)** from the **91st Amendment (2003, deletion of the split exception + CoM cap)** — a common Prelims trap.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Layered legal identity: *Section 29A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 governs registration; the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968 governs recognition and symbols; the Tenth Schedule governs legislative defection. These are not interchangeable.* ***Registration:*** *an association of Indian citizens applies to the ECI and must carry the statutory constitutional-allegiance declaration. Registration does not itself confer National or State party recognition.* ***Bounded deregistration:*** *Indian National Congress (I) v Institute of Social Welfare (2002) treats the ECI's Section 29A function as quasi-judicial and rejects a general merits-based deregistration power, while preserving narrow fraud, non-compliance and unlawful-object situations recognised in the judgment.* ***Recognition and symbols:*** *the Symbols Order supplies performance criteria, reserved/free symbols and paragraph 15 faction adjudication. Sadiq Ali sustains the ECI's party-identity jurisdiction. Recognition lists and election-specific concessions are date-sensitive and deliberately unfrozen.* ***Finance:*** *Sections 29B-29C, the Companies Act, Income-tax law, FCRA and ECI disclosure directions operate through different tests. A contribution threshold, foreign-source rule or candidate-expenditure ceiling must not be transferred to another legal route.* ***Electoral bonds, checked 5 September 2026:*** *Association for Democratic Reforms v Union of India, 2024 INSC 113, remains the controlling official judgment invalidating the scheme and enabling amendments on Article 19(1)(a), proportionality and corporate-funding grounds. It did not enact a complete new campaign-finance code.* ***Criminalisation:*** *ADR (2002) and PUCL (2003) ground candidate disclosure; Lily Thomas removes the former sitting-member protection after conviction; Rambabu Singh Thakur requires party publication of criminal antecedents and reasons for selection. Disclosure is not pre-conviction disqualification.* ***Internal democracy:*** *no comprehensive enacted party-democracy code controls leadership succession, membership and candidate selection. ECI, committee and Law Commission proposals remain proposals.* ***System analysis:*** *national/regional behaviour varies with organisation, territorial base and position in Union or State power. Coalition, centralisation and autonomy claims require evidence and qualification.* ***PYQ firewall:*** *the 2022 GS-II centralisation/autonomy demand is shared with Federal System, while the party-system incentive analysis is owned here. Recognition and finance questions retain exact legal-source labels.*

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 69 and electoral-reforms section (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + ECI update.
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = ECI/court-verified update.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Political-Parties.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 69 and electoral-reforms section (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + ECI update.

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = ECI/court-verified update.

- *Companion: basic/Political-Parties.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / analysis · □ = ECI/court-verified update.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Multi-party system** — national and State-level competition includes recognised and registered-unrecognised parties; avoid unverifiable “largest in the world” claims.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM □: RECALL MAP

PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM □

V

Dimension 1 □ Multi-party system — national and State-level competition includes recognised and registered-unrecognised parties; avoid unverifiable “largest in th	**Dimension 2** □ One-dominant-party phase — Rajni Kothari's “Congress system” describes early dominance; decline was uneven, with later revivals before the coalition
Dimension 3 □□ Ideology, leadership and social bases vary — programmatic commitments coexist with catch-all competition, leadership centralisation and mobilisatio	**Dimension 4** □ Emergence of regional parties; factions & defections; lack of an effective Opposition.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **One-dominant-party phase** — Rajni Kothari's **“Congress system”** describes early dominance; decline was uneven, with later revivals before the coalition era.

- □□ **Ideology, leadership and social bases vary** — programmatic commitments coexist with catch-all competition, leadership centralisation and mobilisation around class, caste, religion, language and region. Avoid declaring most parties ideology-free.

- □ **Emergence of regional parties**; **factions & defections**; **lack of an effective Opposition**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Multi-party system — national and State-level competition includes recognised and registered-unrecognised parties; avoid unverifiable “largest in the world” claims.

2. One-dominant-party phase — Rajni Kothari's **“Congress system”** describes early dominance; decline was uneven, with later revivals before the coalition era.

3. Emergence of regional parties; **factions & defections**; **lack of an effective Opposition**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — FEATURES OF THE INDIAN PARTY SYSTEM □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — RECOGNITION: NATIONAL vs STATE PARTIES □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ The **Election Commission** registers parties (**Sec 29A, RPA 1951**) and grants **national/state** recognition on **poll performance**; the rest are **registered-unrecognised**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The **Election Commission** registers parties (**Sec 29A, RPA 1951**) and grants **national/state** recognition on **poll performance**; the rest are **registered-unrecognised**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — RECOGNITION: NATIONAL vs STATE PARTIES □□

HIGH

Advanced · Privileges of recognition □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Reserved symbol; **one proposer** for nomination; **broadcast time** on state media; access to electoral rolls.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Star campaigners:** RPA Section 77 permits **40** for a recognised political party and **20** for another political party (their travel not counted in candidate expenditure).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Privileges of recognition □

HIGH

Advanced · National party — any ONE condition □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

6% valid votes in **4+ states** (LS or Assembly) **+ 4 LS seats** (from any states); **OR**

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

NATIONAL PARTY — ANY ONE CONDITION □: RECALL MAP

National party — any ONE condition □

V

Dimension 1 6% valid votes in 4+ states (LS or Assembly) + 4 LS seats (from any states); OR	**Dimension 2** 2% of LS seats, with members from 3 states; OR
Dimension 3 Recognised as a state party in 4 states.	

STATIC THEORY

- **2% of LS seats**, with members from **3 states**; **OR**

- Recognised as a **state party in 4 states**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → National party — any ONE condition □

HIGH

Advanced · State party — any ONE condition □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

6% votes in the state (Assembly) **+ 2 Assembly seats**; **OR**

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATE PARTY — ANY ONE CONDITION □: RECALL MAP

State party — any ONE condition □

V

Dimension 1 6% votes in the state (Assembly) + 2 Assembly seats; OR	**Dimension 2** 6% votes (LS from state) + 1 LS seat; OR
Dimension 3 3% of Assembly seats or 3 seats (whichever more); OR	**Dimension 4** 1 LS seat per 25 LS seats allotted to the state; OR

STATIC THEORY

- **6%** votes (LS from state) **+ 1 LS seat**; **OR**

- **3% of Assembly seats or 3 seats** (whichever more); **OR**

- **1 LS seat per 25** LS seats allotted to the state; **OR**

- **8%** of total valid votes in the state (LS or Assembly) — *added in 2011*.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → State party — any ONE condition □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Parties are registered under the Constitution

CORRECT: registered under **Sec 29A, RPA 1951** (a statute).

WRONG: National-party status needs 6% votes in all states

CORRECT: 6% in any 4+ states + 4 LS seats (or the alternatives).

WRONG: Recognised & unrecognised parties get the same star campaigners

CORRECT: 40 vs 20.

WRONG: A "national party" contests only national elections

CORRECT: the label is about **recognition/privileges**, not where it contests.

WRONG: The EC allots a symbol to unrecognised parties too

CORRECT: they pick from **free symbols**; only recognised parties get **reserved** symbols.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks (ECI/court-verified)

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □ **Electoral Bonds struck down** — SC in **Association for Democratic Reforms (Feb 2024)** held the 2018 Electoral Bond Scheme **unconstitutional** (violates the **right to information, Art 19(1)(a)**); ordered the SBI to disclose donor data. □ □ **Recognition status is date-sensitive:** ECI orders revise party status after electoral performance. Quote a current list only when necessary and attach the order/access date.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Debate on bringing parties under the **RTI Act** (CIC held 6 national parties are "public authorities," 2013 — not

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- complied with) and **inner-party democracy** / criminalisation of politics.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks (ECI/court-verified)

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"Money power and opacity threaten Indian democracy." Discuss in light of the Electoral Bonds verdict. Should political parties be brought under the RTI Act? Examine transparency vs autonomy. Regionalisation of the party system: a strength of federal democracy or a source of instability? less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -->

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	GS-II	13	National parties favouring centralisation and regional parties State autonomy	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting ; party system and federal balance both named in the stem	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2022* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-II* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

National parties favouring centralisation and regional parties State autonomy

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 National parties favouring centralisation and regional parties State autonomy	**Dimension 2** The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→	

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Political Parties & the Party System — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI